successfully, we can plan and limit the extreme possibilities.

One of the important developments in this period was the use of quantitative techniques in physical and human geography. These techniques refer to various statistical tools that are used to synthesise the data from maps, field, laboratories and questionnaires. Quantification came about as a result of the expanding scope of the discipline as well the need to understand the processes that were becoming more diversified and complicated.

The quantitative revolution involves the use of statistics, mathematical equations and the use of deterministic models. Many geographers believed that numbers are more precise, and therefore perceived as more scientific compared to words. The map, both as graphic language and visual representation, continues to be used as a geographical tool and at present with the valuable assistance of remote sensing and Geographical Information Systems, map making has become digital and easier especially due to advances in computer and software technologies.

1.4 Themes of Geography

In any subject there will be certain themes, around which the scholars work and contribute. In this way, geography subject also has certain traditional themes. Let us look at them carefully. In 1963, **William D. Pattison** identified the core themes of geographic studies as **'The Four Traditions of Geography'**. These distinct, but related, traditions, of the discipline are: Spatial tradition (areal distributions and spatial patterns. Examples: Population movement) Area studies tradition, (hierarchy of areas, small to large) Man-land tradition (relationship between man and his physical environment) and Earth science tradition (processes of the earth).



Five Themes in Geography

Themes of Geography are the educational tools for understanding the geography subject in detail. It was adopted in the year 1984 by the Association of American Geographers and these five themes were published in the National Council for Geographic Education/Association of American Geographers' publication Guidelines for Geographic Education.

Like the major traditions identified in geography, the significant themes of the subject are also identified. The Association of American Geographers put forward the 'Five themes of Geography' and it has been widely accepted by geographers worldwide (Figure 1.5). The themes are location, place, human – environment interaction, movement and regions.

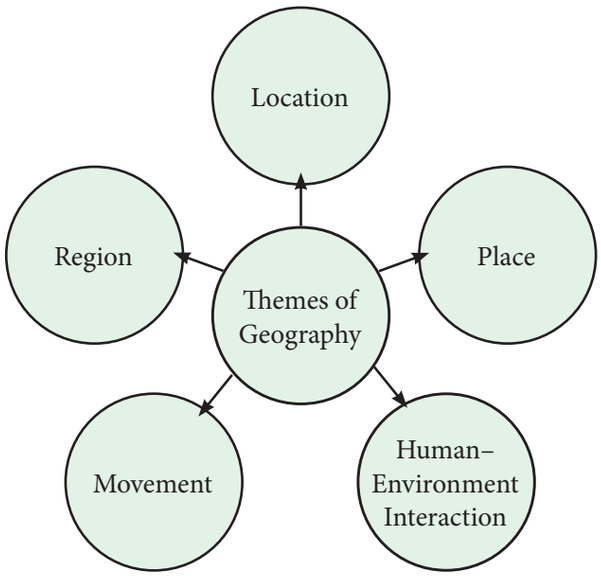


Figure 1.5 Themes of Geography

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